

Haunted computer

Q. Over the past few days, whenever I move my mouse, the pointer starts running by itself and opens unwanted applications. At first, I thought that it might be some sort of virus, so I formatted and reinstalled with an up-to-date version of Norton AntiVirus 2003, but I still face the same problem. I have even removed and reinstalled my mouse driver. It worked for a while, but started acting up again. What's wrong with my PC?

Praveen Tanwar

A Calm down Praveen, there's no need to go chasing mice all over the



place! The solution is actually quite simple. You are probably using Microsoft Office XP with Speech Recognition enabled. The problem is that you haven't configured the Speech Recognition, which often results in 'haunted computer' syndrome. There's no need to go about uninstalling Speech Recognition either, as you might want to use it at a later stage. What you can do immediately is disable it, and

later if you want, you can configure it to your voice. To disable it, go to **Start > Settings > Control Panel > Regional and Language Options**, in the applet go to **Languages > Details**, and check the